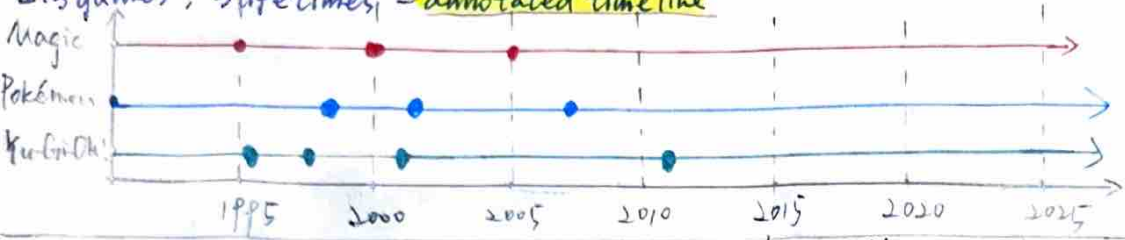
Title: Trading Card Games: from play to collectibles

Subtitle: How card types, sets and rarity changed over 30 years

Liyan Dai
34901426

1. Where did it all begin?

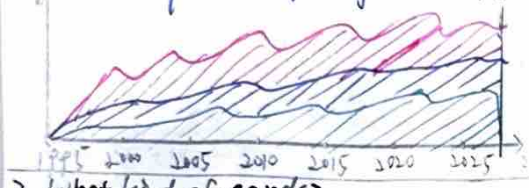
1.3 games, 3 lifetimes, – annotated timeline



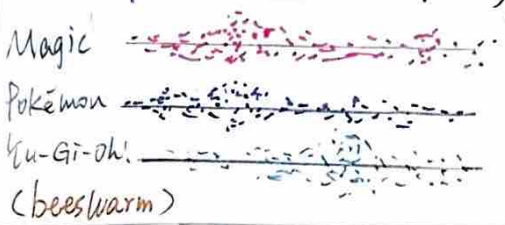
Key milestones for each game

2. More Cards, More sets (Streamgraph)

2a. Cards printed per year. (Key finding about release growth)



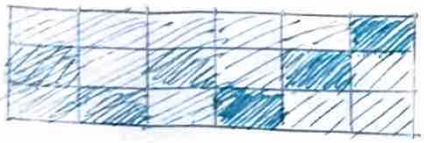
3. How big is a set? (Are sets getting bigger?)



(beeswarm)

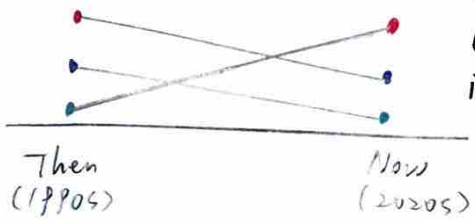
3. What kind of cards?

4. Card types by decade (heatmap)



How card types shifted

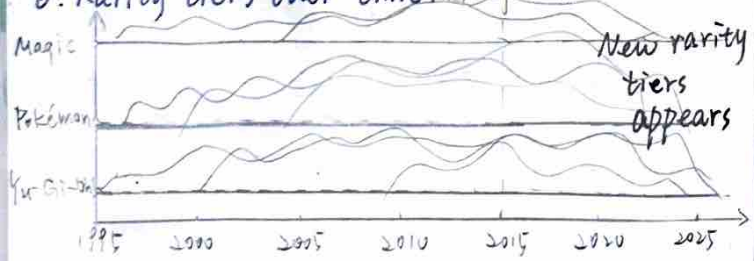
5. Then vs Now. (slope)



Biggest Change in share

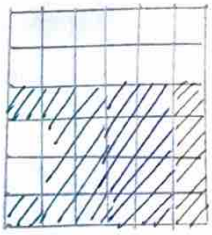
4. Rarity gets complicated

6. Rarity tiers over time. (ridgeline)

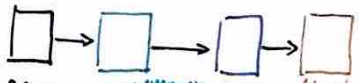


New rarity tiers appears

7. One Pack (waffle).



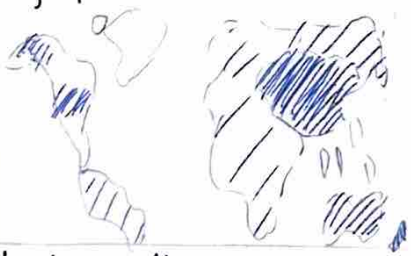
What's inside one pick



5. A Global Hobby (choropleth map)

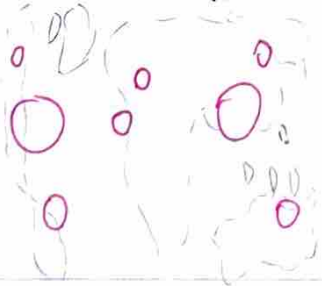
8. Where the world play?

Highlight most active countries.



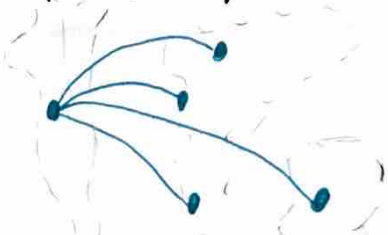
9. Symbol map

where the biggest events are.



10. Flow map.

30 years of moving venues.



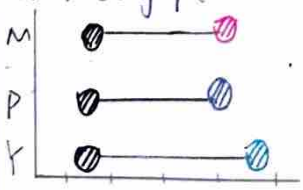
6. Then → Now.

fewer sets → more sets

simple rarity → complex rarity

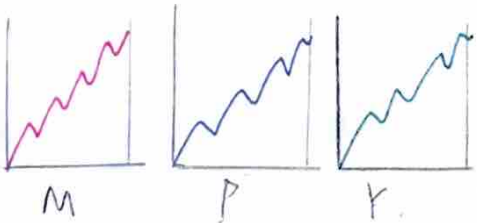
local happy → global culture.

11. Price gap (dumbbell)



Rarity ≠ always value.

12. Small multiples



Three games compared.